

The Game Changers INSTITUTIONS

KALIKAYATNA EDUCATIONAL PROGRAMME Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh

TALK THE WALK

Sitting cosily in one of the classrooms in the government school in Belikere, a bunch of children debate on the source of water. "Eyes are the source of water," says five-year-old Harish. Some of his classmates disagree because tears aren't fresh water. After five minutes, the students draw the image of fresh water in their minds and the discussion takes a different turn. Thanks to Kalikayatna, a joint collaboration of the Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan, Karnataka, and Prajayatna, a development initiative focusing on education in Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh, over 14,000 students have been affected by a novel system of learning that focuses on

how the students learn and not just what they learn. "The existing system tests children on their ability to recall which is unfair," rues H. Kumarswamy, senior faculty, district instructor for education and training. In this project, for instance, students don't learn how to write letters by rote, they first learn words by association and then figure the letters that form these

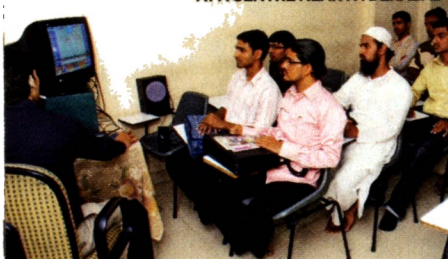
words. "It's almost like we are preparing an army with the same skill sets," says Sreeja, 38, programme coordinator, Prajayatna. The team visits the schools to get feedback from students and its 517 teachers and also trains the latter. "The idea is to personalise the learning process," says Manjunath Bestara, 31, area coordinator of the project. *by Nirmala Ravindran*

MANJUNATH (RIGHT) WITH A PRIMARY SCHOOL TEACHER OF KALIKAYATNA PROGRAMME



The Karnataka Government has spent **Rs 19 lakh** on the programme.

A PRASHAKAR RAO
A COMPUTER LEARNING PROGRAMME AT A CENTRE NEAR HYDERABAD



TCS Across the Country

READ ALERT

Can a computer make people literate? For villagers enrolled under TCS' computer-based functional literacy (CBFL) programme in Beeramguda village in Andhra Pradesh, yes, it can. Every evening, students aged between 18 and 55 years huddle around their teacher, in this case a computer. In no time, the box springs to life with a multimedia presentation

and words start appearing on the monitor. These words are then broken into its components and students are asked to pronounce them repeatedly. Today, thanks to this programme, many illiterate villagers in different parts of India have learnt to read. Brainchild of former TCS deputy chairman Faqir Chand Kohli, its software was developed in the 90s, but the first such class was held only in 2000. "After attending this programme, people should be able to read bus and train signs," says Ajoy Mukherjee, VP and head, global HR, TCS. "We had first developed it in Telugu but now it is available in Hindi, Marathi, Gujarati, Kannada and Urdu as well," he says. That this project has travelled across 10 states and to faraway South Africa and is taught in nine languages is testimony to its success.

by Jhilmil Motihar

This learning module has helped about **1.2 lakh** villagers in India.

ACTIVITY BASED LEARNING
Tamil Nadu

SCHOOLS OF THOUGHT

THANGAM THENNARASU WITH STUDENTS
AT A PRIMARY SCHOOL IN KOLLIDAM

